

The **.25 ACP** (Automatic Colt Pistol) (**6.35×16mmSR**) is a semi-rimmed, straight-walled centerfire pistol cartridge introduced by John Browning in 1905 alongside the Fabrique Nationale M1905 pistol.

Design

The cartridge is of semi-rimmed design meaning that the rim protrudes slightly beyond the diameter of the base of the cartridge so the cartridge can headspace on the rim.^[2]

Though the .25 ACP was designed for semi-automatic pistols, various .25 ACP revolvers were produced in the early twentieth century by Belgian, French, and German gunmakers such as Adolph Frank and Decker.^[3] In the late twentieth century, Bowen Classic Arms produced a custom Smith & Wesson revolver in .25 ACP.^[4]

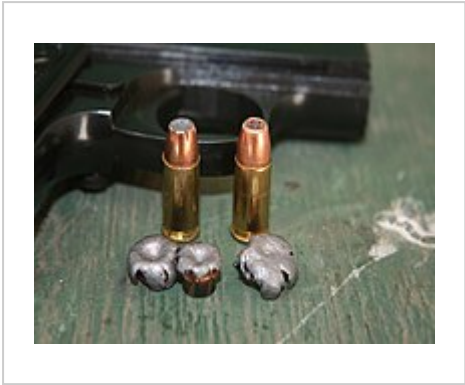
Performance

The use of the .25 ACP allows for a very compact lightweight gun, usually pocket pistol. With quality ammo available on the market, the .25 ACP is viewed by some as a solid choice for personal defense handguns due to its centerfire-case design, which is inherently more reliable than a .22 LR rimfire cartridge.^[5]

.25 ACP	
	
.25 ACP cartridge with scale	
Type	Pistol
Place of origin	<u>United States</u> and <u>Belgium</u>
Production history	
Designer	<u>John Browning</u>
Designed	1905
Produced	1905–present
Specifications	
Case type	Semi-rimmed, straight
Bullet diameter	.2512 in (6.38 mm)
Land diameter	.2429 in (6.17 mm)
Neck diameter	.276 in (7.0 mm)
Base diameter	.278 in (7.1 mm)
Rim diameter	.302 in (7.7 mm)



FN 1905/6



Modern jacketed hollow point loads for 6.35mm/.25 cal.

Rim thickness	.043 in (1.1 mm)	
Case length	.615 in (15.6 mm)	
Overall length	.91 in (23 mm)	
Rifling twist	1:16	
Primer type	<u>Pocket pistol</u>	
Maximum pressure	25,000 psi (170 MPa)	
Maximum CUP	25,000 ^[1] CUP	
Ballistic performance		
Bullet mass/type	Velocity	Energy
35 gr (2 g)	900 ft/s	63 ft·lbf
JHP	(270 m/s)	(85 J)
45 gr (3 g)	815 ft/s	66 ft·lbf
JHP	(248 m/s)	(89 J)
50 gr (3 g)	760 ft/s	65 ft·lbf
FMJ	(230 m/s)	(88 J)
Test barrel length: 2"		
Source(s): <u>Guns & Ammo Magazine</u> (<u>http://www.gunsandammomag.com/ballistics/25_auto.html</u>)		



The Walther Model 9 pistol uses 6.35mm



Bauer .25 Auto pocket pistol



Raven MP-25 .25 ACP chrome with faux mother of pearl grips and push up safety

See also

- 6 mm caliber – Firearm cartridge classification
- Table of handgun and rifle cartridges

References

1. Saami pressures. (n.d.). Retrieved May 3, 2023, from https://leverguns.com/articles/saami_pressures.htm
2. *Wilson, R. K. *Textbook of Automatic Pistols*. Plantersville, SC: Small Arms Technical Publishing Company, 1943. p. 258. ISBN 978-0-935632-89-7.
3. Hogg, Ian; Walter, John (2004-08-29). *Pistols of the World*. David & Charles. ISBN 0873494601.
4. Bowen, Hamilton. *The Custom Revolver*. Privately printed, 2001. ISBN 978-0-9713366-0-5.
5. Jerry Ahern (2010), *Gun Digest Buyer's Guide to Concealed-Carry Handguns*, Gun Digest Books, pp. 19–20, ISBN 978-1-4402-1383-0

External links

- Ballistics By The Inch .25ACP results. (<http://www.ballisticsbytheinch.com/25auto.html>)

- [SAAMI Entry \(https://web.archive.org/web/20160328083009/http://www.saami.org/pubresources/cc_drawings/Pistol/25%20Automatic.pdf\)](https://web.archive.org/web/20160328083009/http://www.saami.org/pubresources/cc_drawings/Pistol/25%20Automatic.pdf)
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